

EUROPEAN COURT OF HUMAN RIGHTS
COUR EUROPÉENNE DES DROITS DE L'HOMME

FIFTH SECTION

CASE OF MEDVEDEV AND OTHERS v. RUSSIA

(Applications nos. 38642/21 and 18 others –
see appended list)

JUDGMENT

STRASBOURG

16 May 2024

This judgment is final but it may be subject to editorial revision.



In the case of Medvedev and Others v. Russia,

The European Court of Human Rights (Fifth Section), sitting as a Committee composed of:

María Elósegui*, President*,
Mattias Guyomar,
Kateřina Šimáčková*, judges*,

and Viktoriya Maradudina, *Acting Deputy Section Registrar,*

Having deliberated in private on 18 April 2024,

Delivers the following judgment, which was adopted on that date:

PROCEDURE

1. The case originated in applications against Russia lodged with the Court under Article 34 of the Convention for the Protection of Human Rights and Fundamental Freedoms ("the Convention") on the various dates indicated in the appended table.

2. The Russian Government ("the Government") were given notice of the applications.

THE FACTS

3. The list of applicants and the relevant details of the applications are set out in the appended table.

4. The applicants complained of the disproportionate measures taken against them as organisers or participants of public assemblies. They also raised other complaints under the provisions of the Convention.

THE LAW

I. JOINDER OF THE APPLICATIONS

5. Having regard to the similar subject matter of the applications, the Court finds it appropriate to examine them jointly in a single judgment.

II. JURISDICTION

6. The Court observes that the facts giving rise to the alleged violations of the Convention occurred prior to 16 September 2022, the date on which the Russian Federation ceased to be a party to the Convention. The Court therefore decides that it has jurisdiction to examine the present applications (see *Fedotova and Others v. Russia* [GC], nos. 40792/10 and 2 others, §§ 68-73, 17 January 2023).

III. ALLEGED VIOLATION OF ARTICLE 11 OF THE CONVENTION

7. The applicants complained principally of disproportionate measures taken against them as organisers or participants of public assemblies, namely their arrest in relation to the dispersal of these assemblies and their conviction for administrative offences. They relied, expressly or in substance, on Article 11 of the Convention.

8. The Court refers to the principles established in its case-law regarding freedom of assembly (see *Kudrevičius and Others v. Lithuania* [GC], no. 37553/05, ECHR 2015, with further references) and proportionality of interference with it (see *Oya Ataman v. Turkey*, no. 74552/01, ECHR 2006-XIV, and *Hyde Park and Others v. Moldova*, no. 33482/06, 31 March 2009).

9. In the leading cases of *Frumkin v. Russia,* no. 74568/12, ECHR 2016 (extracts), *Navalnyy and Yashin v. Russia,* no. 76204/11, 4 December 2014, and *Kasparov and Others v. Russia,* no. 21613/07, 3 October 2013, the Court already found a violation in respect of issues similar to those in the present case.

10. Having examined all the material submitted to it, the Court has not found any fact or argument capable of persuading it to reach a different conclusion as to the admissibility and merits of these complaints. Having regard to its case-law on the subject, the Court considers that in the instant case the interferences with the applicants' freedom of assembly were not "necessary in a democratic society".

11. These complaints are therefore admissible and disclose a breach of Article 11 of the Convention.

IV. OTHER ALLEGED VIOLATIONS UNDER WELL-ESTABLISHED CASE-LAW

12. Some applicants submitted other complaints which also raised issues under the Convention and its Protocols, given the relevant well-established case-law of the Court (see appended table). These complaints are not manifestly ill-founded within the meaning of Article 35 § 3 (a) of the Convention, nor are they inadmissible on any other ground. Accordingly, they must be declared admissible.

13. Having examined all the material before it, the Court concludes that these complaints also disclose violations of the Convention and its Protocols in the light of its findings in *Butkevich v. Russia*, no. 5865/07, §§ 63-65, 13 February 2018, *Tsvetkova and Others v. Russia*, nos. 54381/08 and 5 others, §§ 115-31, 10 April 2018, and *Korneyeva v. Russia*, no. 72051/17, §§ 34-36, 8 October 2019, as to various aspects of unlawful deprivation of liberty of organisers or participants of public assemblies; *Karelin v. Russia*, no. 926/08, §§ 58-85, 20 September 2016, concerning the absence of a

prosecuting party in the proceedings under the Code of Administrative Offences (the CAO); and *Martynyuk v. Russia*, no. 13764/15, §§ 38-42, 8 October 2019, relating to the lack of suspensive effect of an appeal against the sentence of administrative detention.

V. REMAINING COMPLAINTS

14. Some applicants raised further additional complaints under Article 6 of the Convention concerning other aspects of fairness of the administrative-offence proceedings. In view of the findings above, the Court considers that there is no need to deal separately with these remaining complaints.

VI. APPLICATION OF ARTICLE 41 OF THE CONVENTION

15. Regard being had to the documents in its possession and to its case-law (see in particular *Navalnyy and Others v. Russia* [Committee], nos. 25809/17 and 14 others, § 22, 4 October 2022), the Court finds it reasonable to award the sums indicated in the appended table.

FOR THESE REASONS, THE COURT, UNANIMOUSLY,

1. *Decides* to join the applications;

2. *Holds* that it has jurisdiction to deal with these applications as they relate to facts that took place before 16 September 2022;

3. *Declares* the complaints under Article 11 of the Convention and the other complaints under the well-established case-law of the Court, as set out in the appended table, admissible, and *finds* that there is no need to examine separately the remaining complaints under Article 6 of the Convention;

4. *Holds* that these applications disclose a breach of Article 11 of the Convention;

5. *Holds* that there has been a violation of the Convention and the Protocols thereto as regards the other complaints raised under the well-established case-law of the Court (see appended table);

6. *Holds*
   (a) that the respondent State is to pay the applicants, within three months, the amounts indicated in the appended table, to be converted into the currency of the respondent State at the rate applicable at the date of settlement;

(b) that from the expiry of the above-mentioned three months until settlement simple interest shall be payable on the above amounts at a rate equal to the marginal lending rate of the European Central Bank during the default period plus three percentage points.

Done in English, and notified in writing on 16 May 2024, pursuant to Rule 77 §§ 2 and 3 of the Rules of Court.

Viktoriya Maradudina	María Elósegui
Acting Deputy Registrar	President

APPENDIX

List of applications raising complaints under Article 11 of the Convention
(disproportionate measures against organisers and participants of public assemblies)

No.	Application no. Date of introduction	Applicant's name Year of birth	Representative's name and location	Name of the public event Location Date	Administrative / criminal offence	Penalty	Final domestic decision Court Name Date	Other complaints under well-established case-law	Amount awarded for pecuniary and non-pecuniary damage and costs and expenses per applicant (in euros)[1]
1.	38642/21 15/07/2021	**Artem Mikhaylovich MEDVEDEV** 1989	Memorial Human Rights Centre Moscow	Rally "Free Navalnyy" Moscow 31/01/2021	article 20.2 § 6.1 of CAO	detention for 5 days	Moscow City Court 10/02/2021	Art. 5 (1) - unlawful detention - detention in the police van between 12.27 p.m. and 2:25 p.m. on 31/01/2021, escorting to and detention at the police station for compiling an offence record between 2:25 p.m. 31/01/2021 and 3:00 p.m. on 01/02/2021, Art. 6 (1) - lack of impartiality of the tribunal in view of the absence of a prosecuting party in administrative-offence proceedings, Prot. 7 Art. 2 - delayed review of conviction by a higher tribunal - the sentence of administrative detention imposed on the applicant was executed immediately, on account of the lack of suspensive effect of an appeal under the CAO	5,000
2.	44708/21 12/08/2021	**Vladimir Olegovich SEREBRYAKOV** 1994	Glukhov Aleksey Vladimirovich Novocheboksarsk	Rally "Free Navalnyy" Cheboksary 23/01/2021	article 20.2 § 5 of CAO	fine of RUB 10,000	Supreme Court of the Chuvashia Republic 06/05/2021	Art. 6 (1) - lack of impartiality of the tribunal in view of the absence of a prosecuting party in administrative-offence proceedings	3,500

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3.	47075/21 07/09/2021	**Aleksandr Arkadyevich STURCHAK** 1987	Memorial Human Rights Centre Moscow	Rally "Free Navalnyy" Moscow 31/01/2021	article 20.2 § 6.1 of CAO	detention for 7 days	Moscow City Court 12/03/2021	Art. 5 (1) - unlawful detention - escorting to the police station on 31/01/2021 for compiling administrative offence record and detention at the police station between 12:25 p.m. on 31/01/2021 and 3:00 p.m. on 01/02/2021, Art. 6 (1) - lack of impartiality of the tribunal in view of the absence of a prosecuting party in administrative-offence proceedings, Prot. 7 Art. 2 - delayed review of conviction by a higher tribunal - the sentence of administrative detention imposed on the applicant was executed immediately, on account of the lack of suspensive effect of an appeal under the CAO	5,000
4.	60623/21 06/12/2021	**Andrey Vladimirovich PRYTKOV** 1979	Memorial Human Rights Centre Moscow	Rally "Free Navalnyy" Tumen 23/01/2021 Rally "Free Navalnyy" Tumen 31/01/2021	article 20.2 § 5 of CAO article 20.2 § 5 of CAO	fine of RUB 15,000 fine of RUB 17,000	Tyumen Regional Court 14/07/2021 Tyumen Regional Court 07/06/2021	Art. 6 (1) - lack of impartiality of the tribunal in view of the absence of a prosecuting party in administrative-offence proceedings - in both sets of administrative proceedings (concerning the events of 23/01/2021 and 31/01/2021),	3,500

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5.	61338/21 03/12/2021	**Aleksandr Aleksandrovich ROMANENKO** 1991	Memorial Human Rights Centre Moscow	Rally "Free Navalnyy" Moscow 23/01/2021 Rally "Free Navalnyy" Moscow 21/04/2021	article 20.2 § 5 of CAO article 20.2 § 6.1 of CAO	fine of RUB 10,000 fine of RUB 10,000	Moscow City Court 23/06/2021 Moscow City Court 01/10/2021	Art. 5 (1) - unlawful detention - escorting to and detention at the police station for compiling an offence record between: 3:00 p.m. on 23/01/2021 and 11:10 p.m. on 23/01/2021; 4:30 p.m. on 25/04/2021 (4 days after the participation in the rally) and 11:00 p.m. on 26/04/2021, Art. 6 (1) - lack of impartiality of the tribunal in view of the absence of a prosecuting party in administrative-offence proceedings - in both sets of administrative proceedings (concerning the events of 23/01/2021 and 21/04/2021)	4,000
6.	61724/21 10/12/2021	**Nikita Leonidovich IGONIN** 2000	Memorial Human Rights Centre Moscow	Rally "Free Navalnyy" Nizhniy Novgorod 31/01/2021	article 20.2 § 5 of CAO	fine of RUB 5,000	Nizhniy Novgorod Regional Court 21/07/2021	Art. 5 (1) - unlawful detention - escorting to and detention at the police station for compiling an offence record between 12:20 p.m. and 9:45 p.m. on 31/01/2021, Art. 6 (1) - lack of impartiality of the tribunal in view of the absence of a prosecuting party in administrative-offence proceedings	4,000
7.	8381/22 25/01/2022	**Vladislav Igorevich BELYAYEV** 2000	Memorial Human Rights Centre Moscow	Rally "Free Navalnyy" Moscow 31/01/2021	article 20.2 § 5 of CAO	fine of RUB 20,000	Moscow City Court 27/07/2021	Art. 5 (1) - unlawful detention - escorting to the police station for compiling an offence record and detention there between 5:40 p.m. and 8:55 p.m. on 31/01/2021, Art. 6 (1) - lack of impartiality of the tribunal in view of the absence of a prosecuting party in administrative-offence proceedings	4,000

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8.	8420/22 25/01/2022	**Dmitriy Andreyevich ILYIN** 1998	Memorial Human Rights Centre Moscow	Rally "Free Navalnyy" Moscow 02/02/2021	article 20.2 § 6.1 of CAO	detention for 6 days	Moscow City Court 29/07/2021	Art. 5 (1) - unlawful detention - escorting to and detention at the police station for compiling an offence record between 11:30 p.m. on 02/02/2021 and 5:00 p.m. on 04/02/2021, Art. 6 (1) - lack of impartiality of the tribunal in view of the absence of a prosecuting party in administrative-offence proceedings, Prot. 7 Art. 2 - delayed review of conviction by a higher tribunal - the sentence of administrative detention imposed on the applicant was executed immediately, on account of the lack of suspensive effect of an appeal under the CAO	5,000
9.	8441/22 12/01/2022	**Miroslav Vladlenovich BUYNOV** 1996	Polyakov Daniil Alekseyevich Voronezh	Rally "Free Navalnyy" Voronezh 31/01/2021	article 20.2 § 5 of CAO	fine of RUB 10,000	Voronezh Regional Court 12/07/2021	Art. 6 (1) - lack of impartiality of the tribunal in view of the absence of a prosecuting party in administrative-offence proceedings	3,500
10.	8472/22 25/01/2022	**Ivan Ilyich DOROFEYEV** 1999	Memorial Human Rights Centre Moscow	Meeting with a candidate running for parliamentary elections Moscow 26/07/2021	article 19.3 § 1 of CAO	detention for 5 days	Moscow City Court 30/07/2021	Art. 5 (1) - unlawful detention - escorting to and detention at the police station for compiling an offence record between 7:34 p.m. on 26/07/2021 and 3:30 p.m. on 27/07/2021, Art. 6 (1) - lack of impartiality of the tribunal in view of the absence of a prosecuting party in administrative-offence proceedings, Prot. 7 Art. 2 - delayed review of conviction by a higher tribunal - the sentence of administrative detention imposed on the applicant was executed immediately, on account of the lack of suspensive effect of an appeal under the CAO	5,000

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11.	8475/22 25/01/2022	**Viktor Petrovich KOCHKIN** 1995	Memorial Human Rights Centre Moscow	Rally "Free Navalnyy" Moscow 31/01/2021	article 20.2 § 6.1 of CAO	fine of RUB 10,000	Moscow City Court 11/08/2021	Art. 5 (1) - unlawful detention - escorting to and detention at the police station for compiling an offence record between 12:25 p.m. on 31/01/2021 and 0:30 a.m. on 01/02/2021, Art. 6 (1) - lack of impartiality of the tribunal in view of the absence of a prosecuting party in administrative-offence proceedings	4,000
12.	8499/22 14/01/2022	**Pavel Andreyevich SAUTKIN** 2000	Usanova Olimpiada Valentinovna Nizhniy Novgorod	Rally "Free Navalnyy" Nizhniy Novgorod 31/01/2021	article 20.2 § 5 of CAO	fine of RUB 5,000	Nizhniy Novgorod Regional Court 15/07/2021	Art. 5 (1) - unlawful detention - escorting to and detention at the police station for compiling an offence record between 12:25 p.m. and 11:00 p.m. on 31/01/2021, Art. 6 (1) - lack of impartiality of the tribunal in view of the absence of a prosecuting party in administrative-offence proceedings	4,000
13.	8805/22 22/01/2022	**Roman Rinatovich MIFTAKHUTDINOV** 2003	Pershakova Yelena Yuryevna Moscow	Rally "Free Navalnyy" Krasnoyarsk 23/01/2021	article 20.2 § 5 of CAO	fine of RUB 10,000	Krasnoyarsk Regional Court 22/07/2021	Art. 5 (1) - unlawful detention - escorting to and detention at the police station for compiling an offence record between 6:10 p.m. and 10:30 p.m. on 23/01/2021, Art. 6 (1) - lack of impartiality of the tribunal in view of the absence of a prosecuting party in administrative-offence proceedings	4,000
14.	9460/22 31/01/2022	**Mikhail Dmitriyevich MOROZOV** 2001	Pershakova Yelena Yuryevna Moscow	Rally "Free Navalnyy" Krasnoyarsk 23/01/2021	article 20.2 § 5 of CAO	fine of RUB 12,000	Krasnoyarsk Regional Court 27/10/2021	Art. 5 (1) - unlawful detention - escorting to the police station for compiling an offence record on 23/01/2021, Art. 6 (1) - lack of impartiality of the tribunal in view of the absence of a prosecuting party in administrative-offence proceedings	4,000

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15.	11442/22 01/02/2022	**Ilya Daniilovich STEPANOV** 1998	Memorial Human Rights Centre Moscow	Rally "Free Navalnyy" Moscow` 02/02/2021	article 20.2 § 5 of CAO	fine of RUB 20,000	Moscow City Court 03/08/2021	Art. 5 (1) - unlawful detention - escorting to and detention at the police station for compiling an offence record between 11:10 a.m. and 5:30 p.m. on 02/02/2021, Art. 6 (1) - lack of impartiality of the tribunal in view of the absence of a prosecuting party in administrative-offence proceedings	4,000
16.	11567/22 28/01/2022	**Renat Maratovich KHAKIMOV** 1999	Dubrovina Marina Alekseyevna Novorossiysk	Rally "Free Navalnyy" Krasnodar 21/04/2021	article 20.2 § 5 of CAO	fine of RUB 15,000	Krasnodar Regional Court 04/10/2021	Art. 6 (1) - lack of impartiality of the tribunal in view of the absence of a prosecuting party in administrative-offence proceedings -	3,500
17.	12287/22 24/02/2022	**Shukrullo Nurulloyevich ALIMOV** 1988	Prosvirkina Kseniya Dmitriyevna Moscow	Rally to support Izzat Amon Moscow 02/04/2021	article 20.2 § 5 of CAO	fine of RUB 10,000	Moscow City Court 27/08/2021	Art. 5 (1) - unlawful detention - escorting to and detention at the police station for compiling an offence record between 11:15 a.m. and 8:50 p.m. on 02/04/2021, Art. 6 (1) - lack of impartiality of the tribunal in view of the absence of a prosecuting party in administrative-offence proceedings,	4,000
18.	13893/22 28/02/2022	**Roman Sergeyevich KURLYKIN** 1988	Prosvirkina Kseniya Dmitriyevna Moscow	Rally "Free Navalnyy" Voronezh 21/04/2021	article 20.2 § 5 of CAO	fine of RUB 10,000	Voronezh Regional Court 31/08/2021	Art. 5 (1) - unlawful detention - escorting to and detention at the police station for compiling an offence record between 7:35 p.m. on 21/04/2021 and 0:30 a.m. on 22/04/2021, Art. 6 (1) - lack of impartiality of the tribunal in view of the absence of a prosecuting party in administrative-offence proceedings	4,000

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19.	30525/22 22/02/2022	**David Vladimirovich SHESTAKOV** 1989	Prosvirkina Kseniya Dmitriyevna Moscow	Rally "Free Navalnyy" Voronezh 21/04/2021	article 20.2 § 5 of CAO	fine of RUB 10,000	Voronezh Regional Court 24/08/2021	Art. 5 (1) - unlawful detention - escorting to the police station for compiling an offence record on 21/04/2021, Art. 6 (1) - lack of impartiality of the tribunal in view of the absence of a prosecuting party in administrative-offence proceedings	4,000

[1] Plus any tax that may be chargeable to the applicants.